

# EXPENSE AND TRAVEL POLICY



## PURPOSE

The purpose of the Company travel policy is to define and establish guidelines on Company business expenses and travel in a clear and consistent manner. At all times, the aim is to ensure that our Employees travel safely and that business objectives are met cost effectively. Employees are responsible for understanding the Company expense and travel policy, and ensuring that all travels and expenses comply with it.

In keeping with the Company culture, this procedure minimizes directives and instructions and therefore the Company is relying on individual responsibility and ownership from all employees when it comes to business travel and related expenditure. The main purpose is to secure an optimal work and travel experience at a reasonable cost.

## SCOPE

The Company's travel procedure encompasses all employees and contractors working and traveling on behalf of the Company.

## **BEFORE**

The first evaluation to make, from a company cost perspective, is to evaluate if the expense / travel is necessary. When it is considered necessary, and no other means of communication can be used, the following cost elements should be followed to ensure the most cost-effective expense / travel.

### **Approval**

Employees need to obtain a written approval before the business expense with an estimated cost. Expenses over NZD \$1000 must be approved in advance by the manager.

All business travel must be approved in advance by the manager.

### **Reimbursable Expenses:**

Expense Reports: Employees must submit an expense report for all business-related expenses, including receipts or other documentation as proof of payment. Expense reports must be submitted within 1 month of the expense being incurred.

The company will reimburse employees for reasonable and necessary expenses incurred while conducting company business. This includes, but is not limited to, the following types of expenses:

- Travel expenses, including airfare, rental car, and hotel accommodations
- Meal expenses, including meals while traveling and business-related meals with clients or customers
- Supplies and equipment necessary for company business
- Professional development and training expenses

Non-Reimbursable Expenses: The following types of expenses are not eligible for reimbursement:

- Personal expenses, such as groceries or entertainment
- Luxury or unnecessary items
- Expenses that are not properly documented or submitted for approval in advance.

**Use of Company Credit Cards:** If an employee is provided with a company credit card, it should only be used for business-related expenses. The employee is responsible for ensuring that all charges are appropriate and properly documented.

## **SAFETY**

Employees are expected to take all necessary precautions to ensure their safety while traveling. This includes, but is not limited to, following all safety guidelines and procedures, and carrying any necessary personal protective equipment.

Employees are personally responsible for Company documents and equipment (including laptops, mobile devices, hardware and software). These items should be carried as hand luggage as far as possible.

### **Risk Mitigation**

At all times, the number of employees traveling together on business should be minimized.

- ☐ A maximum of 10 employees from the Company are permitted to fly on the same airplane without prior approval from the Company CEO.
- ☐ A limit of 3 members of the management team can travel by air together without prior approval of the Company CEO.

### **Banned Airlines**

For the sake of safety, do not use airlines which at the time of booking are banned by the European Union, as listed below:

*Chromeextension://efaidnbmninnibpcajpcglclefindmkaj/https://transport.ec.europa.eu/system/files/2022-11/air-safety-list-2022-11-23\_en.pdf*

### **Vaccinations**

Vaccination might be needed in some countries to protect you. For guidance and updated information regarding safe travel, please visit <https://wwwnc.cdc.gov/travel/>. Please consult your personal physician regarding vaccination requirements for the places you intend to visit. The costs for such vaccinations will be reimbursed / covered by the Company.

### **Travel Insurance**

The Company has put in place a Group Travel Insurance for all employees and contractors contracted with ICS and HSC. This insurance covers only business travel and is not applicable from home to office.

## GENERAL AND TRAVELLING EXPENSES

### Flight Travel

#### Category of Travel by Flight:

| Job Level                     | Class of Travel                                                               |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Management Team and Directors | Less than 5 hours: Economy class<br>More than 5 hours: Business class         |
| All Others                    | Less than 5 hours: Economy class<br>More than 5 hours: Premium Economy class* |

The 5 hours is calculated as the total airborne time.

\* Where Premium Economy class is not available, Economy class applies.

Should you be eligible to travel business class, please note you may not convert your ticket to a lower class to enable accompanying passengers.

In cases where a cost-effective business class ticket is not available, premium economy or economy class must be selected.

### Booking in advance

Flights must be booked or reserved by the traveller by planning in advance as much as possible to secure economical fares. Airline tickets increase in cost closer to departure date due to availability.

### Road Travel

**Airport Pickup:** Employees are recommended to use airport express trains or shuttle services wherever possible and efficient. Local taxis should be used in all other circumstances.

**Private vehicle:** Employees may use a private vehicle for business purposes if it is less expensive than alternatives such as rental car, taxi etc. or if it significantly saves time. Ensuring insurance coverage in such cases is the responsibility of the traveller. The standard mileage reimbursement rate is regulated within each country. The rate considers all actual automobile expenses such as fuel, lubrication, towing charges, repairs, replacements, tires, depreciation, insurance, etc.

**Rental car:** Rental car use shall be kept to a minimum and a medium size car shall be rented. To avoid double insurance coverage and extra cost, the traveller must check their travel insurance and existing insurances coverage with the Company before accepting additional insurance from the rental car company. The fuel tank shall be refilled before returning the rental car to avoid extra cost.

## **Hotel, Food & Beverages**

The Company always expects the traveller to exercise cost conscientiousness when selecting hotels and dining options, including locations of same.

The employee shall be provided with safe hotel accommodation of between 3-star to 4-star rating or equivalent for the actual duration of the business trip. Any additional stay for pre or post business activities will be at the employee's own expense. This may be varied by prior written agreement of the manager.

### **Meals**

Employees should select restaurants which are reasonably priced for the locality, and which are consistent with normal living standards.

### **Entertainment**

Entertainment expenses (e.g. any meals, tickets for events, drinks and so on) are only accepted when incurred in connection with Company business and approved by the Manager. Please state the business reason, company name and names of people entertained. Claims without such declaration will be rejected.

### **Laundry**

Reasonable expenses for laundry may be reimbursed if Employee is on continuous travel exceeding 7 nights. Actual expenses may be reimbursed provided these are supported with itemized receipts.

## **AFTER**

### **Reporting Travel Expenses**

All expenses including Company pre-paid bills and invoiced expenses must be included in the expense claim.

The approved expense claims must be submitted within 1 month from receipt date.

Original or electronic receipts must be attached to support the expense claim. A clear description of each expense must be given on the claim form; especially in cases where receipts cannot reasonably be obtained (e.g. taxi in certain countries). The receipts must be submitted together with the expense claim.

Compliance: Employees are expected to comply with this expense and travel policy and all applicable laws and regulations when incurring and reporting business-related expenses and traveling on company business. Any violation of this policy may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

### **No Reimbursement where the Travel Policy has been breached.**

Additional costs arising from breach of this policy may not be claimable or refundable unless the traveller (prior to travelling) received written approval from their manager.

### **Cancellations, Visas and Passports**

The Company will reimburse cost for required visas, and passports in the context of business travel. Passports must always be valid for at least a further 6 months during the trip. Travellers are responsible for renewing their passports on time. The costs for renewal of passports can be paid by the Company. The Company will not cover any such costs if solely for non-business private travel.

“No-show” charges due to the negligence of the traveller will be at the traveller’s own expense. Furthermore, it is the responsibility of the traveller to:

- Cancel unused e-tickets within the deadline stated in the ticket.
- Ensure that the unused e-tickets are refunded to the company or the traveler’s corporate credit card.

Any unused e-tickets not cancelled before the deadline will be at the traveller’s own expense.

### **Travel Time**

Travel time is regarded as working time but does not qualify for either time payments or additional salary allowances, regardless of the day on which the journey was made.

Please be reminded that on all business trips, you are the Company’s ambassador and must live our Company Values!

## EMERGENCY ASSISTANCE



24 hours a day, 365 days a year Emergency Global Assistance

|                          |                            |
|--------------------------|----------------------------|
| Call (costs reimbursed): | +64 9 487 0815             |
| Within NZ                | 0800 778 109               |
| Policy Number:           | 714200319                  |
| Policy Name:             | Hawaiki Submarine Cable LP |
| Policy Type:             | Premier Corporate Travel   |

For New Zealand- based employees

|                          |                            |
|--------------------------|----------------------------|
| Call (costs reimbursed): | +64 9 487 0815             |
| Within NZ                | 0800 778 109               |
| Policy Number:           | 714200319                  |
| Policy Name:             | Hawaiki Submarine Cable LP |
| Policy Type:             | Premier Corporate Travel   |

For Australia- based employees

### What Allianz Partners provides:

- Emergency travel assistance.
- Emergency medical evacuation.
- Payment of evacuation expenses, including necessary expenses incurred for qualified medical staff to accompany an insured person.
- Medically supervised repatriation.
- Repatriation, which will be organised by Allianz Partners by the most appropriate method, including, if necessary, the use of air services.
- Assistance in replacing a lost or stolen passport.
- Legal assistance.
- Payment of other emergency assistance expenses.